

How Much Can You Really Make With a Moving Company?

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Let's skip the generic "it depends" answer. You want real numbers — what operators actually earn, what it costs to run the business, and what the ceiling looks like if you execute well.

Here's the honest breakdown.

The Formula That Runs This Business

Moving company revenue comes down to three numbers:

Trucks × Jobs per truck per week × Average revenue per job = Your weekly revenue

Everything else — crew size, equipment, marketing — is either a cost against that number or a lever that moves it up or down.

What a Single Moving Truck Can Generate

This varies by move type and market, but here are realistic numbers for a standard local moving operation:

Residential local moves (2 to 4 hours, 2-person crew):

- Average job revenue: \$350 to \$650
- Jobs per truck per day (aggressive): 2
- Jobs per truck per week (5 days): 6 to 8
- Weekly revenue per truck: \$2,100 to \$5,200
- Monthly revenue per truck: \$8,400 to \$20,800

Residential local moves (half-day to full-day, 2 to 3-person crew):

- Average job revenue: \$700 to \$1,400
- Jobs per truck per day (realistic): 1 to 1.5
- Jobs per truck per week: 5 to 7
- Weekly revenue per truck: \$3,500 to \$9,800
- Monthly revenue per truck: \$14,000 to \$39,200

Commercial and long-distance:

- Average job revenue: \$2,000 to \$15,000+
- Jobs per month per truck: 4 to 12
- Monthly revenue per truck: \$8,000 to \$90,000+

Realistic Scenarios by Fleet Size

Scenario 1: Solo Operator — 1 Truck, 2-Person Crew

You're owner-operator. You drive the truck and hire one helper per job.

Conservative (5 jobs/week, \$600 average):

- Monthly revenue: \$12,000
- Costs (labor, fuel, insurance, truck payment, equipment): ~\$7,200

- Take-home: ~\$4,800/month

Aggressive (8 jobs/week, \$800 average):

- Monthly revenue: \$25,600
- Costs: ~\$12,000
- Take-home: ~\$13,600/month

The gap between conservative and aggressive isn't luck — it's marketing. The operator who runs 8 jobs per week has consistent inbound demand. The one running 5 is waiting for word-of-mouth.

Scenario 2: Growing Operation — 3 Trucks, Full Crews

You're managing rather than moving. Each truck has a trained 2-person crew.

Conservative (4 jobs/week per truck, \$700 average):

- Monthly revenue: \$33,600
- Costs (3 crews at \$18/hr each, fuel, insurance, truck payments, overhead): ~\$21,000
- Take-home: ~\$12,600/month

Aggressive (7 jobs/week per truck, \$900 average):

- Monthly revenue: \$75,600
- Costs: ~\$36,000
- Take-home: ~\$39,600/month

Scenario 3: Scaled Operation — 8 Trucks

Full operations with dispatcher, foreman, and back-office support.

Mid-market performance (5 jobs/week per truck, \$800 average):

- Monthly revenue: \$128,000
- Operating costs (labor, vehicles, overhead, marketing): ~\$82,000
- Net: ~\$46,000/month = **\$552,000/year**

This is a real number. Not exceptional — it's what a well-run 8-truck operation in a mid-size market can produce.

The Variables That Move Your Numbers Most

Market size. A metro area with 2 million people has 10x the moving demand of a city with 200,000. Your market is the ceiling on your total addressable revenue.

Move type mix. Local hourly moves vs. flat-rate long-distance moves have completely different economics. Long-distance can generate \$3,000 to \$10,000 per job but require different logistics and licensing (DOT authority for interstate moves). Most operators start local and add long-distance as they grow.

Crew efficiency. Two experienced movers complete jobs faster than two new hires. Faster jobs mean more jobs per day. A 15% improvement in move time translates directly to more revenue per truck per week.

Seasonal variation. Moving demand peaks in summer (May to September) and dips in winter. Operators who manage this well book more jobs in the busy season and control costs in the slow season. Operators who don't plan for it get caught short.

Customer acquisition cost. This is the variable most operators underestimate. An operator paying \$150 per acquired job from a lead platform is significantly less profitable than one paying \$40 through a pay-per-move model or \$0 through organic reviews. At 50 jobs per month, a \$110 difference in acquisition cost is \$5,500/month in margin.

What Eats Your Margin

Labor. Your biggest cost by far. Two movers at \$16 to \$22/hour for a 4-hour move is \$128 to \$176 in labor before any other cost. Multiply by 150 jobs per month and labor alone is \$19,200 to \$26,400. Managing crew efficiency and scheduling density is where margin is made or lost.

Truck costs. Box truck payments or lease, insurance, fuel, and maintenance. Budget \$2,000 to \$3,500/month per truck fully loaded.

Supplies. Blankets, dollies, straps, boxes, tape, shrink wrap. Many operators include basic supplies in their rate. Budget \$20 to \$60 per job.

Claims. Damaged items are the hidden cost most new operators don't price for. Even a well-run operation sees 1 to 2% of jobs result in some claim. Build a claims reserve.

The Ceiling Is Higher Than You Think

The top-performing independent moving companies in mid-size US markets — not national chains, just local operators who built well — generate \$1M to \$3M in annual revenue with 8 to 15 trucks.

At that scale, the owner is managing people and marketing, not moving furniture. The business generates income independent of the owner's physical presence.

That scale is achievable in 3 to 5 years from a single truck start if customer acquisition is treated as seriously as operations from day one.

Want to see what the numbers look like for your specific market? Book a free strategy call and we'll model out your revenue potential based on your local demand and competition level.